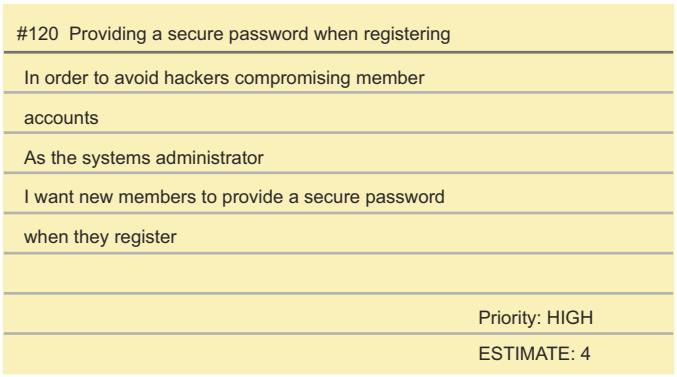


Figure 4.9 A typical user story card format

as a starting point for the tests. But the aim of these acceptance criteria isn't to be definitive or exhaustive. It's unreasonable to expect the product owner or stakeholders to think of a definitive list of the acceptance criteria when the stories are being discovered. You just want enough information to be able to move forward. You'll have plenty of time to refine, expand, and complete them, and to add any additional requirements documentation that the team might need, when it comes to implementing the story, and even later on when you learn more about the requirements.

As you can see in figure 4.10, these user stories look a lot like features, but they tend to be a little lower-level. A user story doesn't have to be deliverable in isolation but can focus on one particular aspect of a feature. User stories can help you plan and organize how you'll build a feature. Although you may not deliver a user story into production by itself, you can and should show implemented stories to end users and other stakeholders, to make sure that you're on the right track and to learn more about the best way to implement the subsequent stories.

You can use user stories to break down the features we discussed in the previous section. For example, figure 4.11 builds on figure 4.4, continuing the investigation of what features might help you reduce lost revenue from lapsed Frequent Flyer memberships.

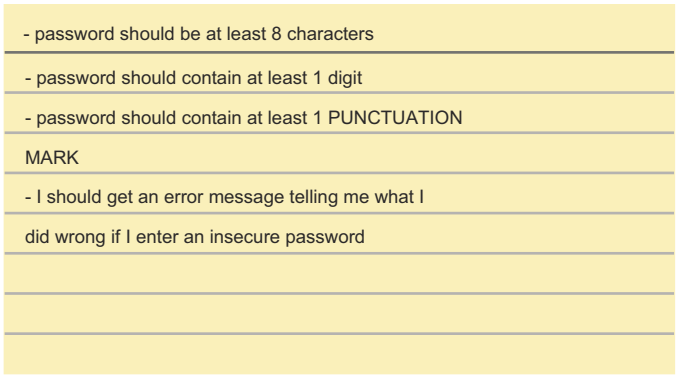


Figure 4.10 You can put an initial list of acceptance criteria on the back of the story card.